

The arithmetic of progress

Seven medals sounds a modest enough number until it is set against history. It was, in fact, as many as India's para-sportspersons had won across every previous Commonwealth Games combined — the sum of decades **matched** in a single fortnight in Glasgow.

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Indian para-sportspersons delivered a stellar performance at the 2026 Commonwealth Games in Glasgow. They deserve full credit for producing the country's best-ever para-sport showing at the Games, returning with seven medals: three gold, two silver and two bronze.

The significance of the haul went well beyond the medal table. In a single Games, India equalled the number of medals it had won across all its previous Commonwealth Games appearances in para sports combined. Para athletics was at the heart of the success, accounting for

six medals, while para powerlifting contributed the seventh.

Glasgow also showed that Indian para sport is gradually improving. Arriving with expectations, the para athletes did not allow the pressure to weigh them down. Instead, they responded with performances that combined determination with supreme confidence. Several of their achievements were historic.

Sharmila Dhankar was the first to make a major statement in the para athletics events. In the women's F57 shot put, the 40-year-old produced a

throw of 9.81m to win gold, making her India's first Commonwealth Games gold medallist in para athletics.

There was more history to be made in the same event. Shilpa K Shyla also found a place on the podium, taking bronze (7.26m) and giving India two medals from a single event, another landmark for the country's para athletics.

The Indian men were not to be left behind as they, too, produced a sterling display. In the T47 100m, Dilip Mahadu Gavit and Mohammed

Double delight: Sharmila Dhankar (left) and Shilpa K Shyla celebrate after winning gold and bronze medals respectively in the women's shot put F57 at the 23rd Commonwealth Games, in Glasgow, Scotland. PTI

